

K. RADHAKRISHNAN, *60*
| CPI(M) |
Alathur (SC), Kerala

Born to plantation workers in the high ranges of Idukki, he still visited his sylvan homestead and worked on the land when he could, even as one of the popular members of the Pinarayi Vijayan cabinet. The textbook humble Marxist politician, he's had five terms as MLA (since 1996), even rising to be speaker. Now, he's the lone CPI(M) MP from Kerala.



SANDIPANRAO BHUMARE, *62*
| SHIV SENA |
Aurangabad, Maharashtra

Aurangabad, or Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar as it has been renamed, was the first city the Shiv Sena planted roots in outside the Mumbai-Thane belt. This time the victor was five-time Paithan MLA Bhumare of the Shinde faction. His rough-and-ready style endured in a triangular contest despite this being outside his home base and allegations of wine shop connections.



NARESH CHANDRA UTTAM PATEL, *68*
| SAMAJWADI PARTY |
Fatehpur, UP

Fateh(pur) for SP's Kurmi leader who upset Sadhvi Niranjan Jyoti's applecart... went a media headline that said it all. A member of Mulayam Yadav's first ministry in 1989, an SP founding-member and its state president till late, Patel's *fateh* (victory) in his Kurmi-dominated home base makes him a clean, educated face in the SP's new caste inclusive contingent.



KOTA SRINIVASA POOJARY, *64*
| BJP | ***Udupi-Chikamagalur, Karnataka***

His humble beginnings enforced a dropout from school in Class 7, yet Poojary's activism ran strong. From age 34, he ran the gamut of state politics, finally rising to ministership. On the side, he also took the literary route—writing columns for the dailies to highlight local issues. Poojary also represents the BJP's success among the OBC Billava community in coastal Karnataka.



ANI

▼ AMARINDER SINGH RAJA WARRING, *46*

| CONGRESS | ***Ludhiana, Punjab***

This Lok Sabha debut is nothing short of thriller web series material. Battling a tangled web of intra-party factionalism, challenging the mightiest outside and finally winning against his best friend. Orphaned while still not a teenager and brought up by his maternal uncles, he created his first splash in the 2012 assembly poll by wresting the Badal bastion Gidderbaha (and never lost his nemesis-like stance towards the family since, even opposing Manpreet Badal when he was a partymate). This time, he shifted constituencies to challenge his best friend Ravneet Bittu who had switched to the BJP. Bittu, despite the loss, is now a Modi 3.0 mantri.



◀ E. TUKARAM, *57*

| CONGRESS |
Bellary, Karnataka

Once an accountant in a mining firm who rose to be a minister in 2018, the four-time MLA from iron ore-rich Sandur, with his saintly name, went up against a biggie in B. Sreeramulu, aide to the (in)famous 'Bellary Brothers'. He's had a busy time since the victory, mostly to deny that he was quitting his seat to join the Siddaramaiah cabinet and affirming that he'd rather work as an MP to fulfil Rahul Gandhi's promise to make Bellary famous for an attire that originated with miners—as India's jeans capital.